

330-inch diagonal, which is big enough to address an audience over 50. Movie results were very decent in both 4:3 and 16:9 aspect ratios. Moreover, the Acer sported a Picture-in-Picture mode, for when you need to showcase a movie presentation alongside the graphs. Acer's remote was also the best of the bunch with some great features that afford flexibility and style. To top it all

up, the Acer asked for the lowest price in this category: Rs 64,990. The Acer PD113 is our 'Best Buy' Gold winner.

The Sony VPL-ES2, our 'Best Buy' Silver winner, is an LCD projector. It has an impressive design; setting it up is fast and painless and using it is a breeze. Alongside its preset modes, the Sony allows for three user-configurable modes, which is a nice plus, indeed. As mentioned earlier, the

working cost of the Sony is much less than that of any other projector we evaluated: the lamp costs just Rs 6 per hour. This means that even if you make a one-hour presentation per day, five days a week, your cost won't exceed Rs 30 per month.

MOBILE PROJECTORS

Anything that weighed less than two kg was considered a mobile projector. A total of four such units made it to this category. All four models that made it here were SVGA and except for the Panasonic, an LCD-based model, the rest were DLP-based projectors.

What Did They Offer?

Being SVGA, all four offered the 800x600 resolution that their larger-sized brethren did.



Acer PD113



Sony VPL-ES2

BEST BUY
digit
JANUARY 2005

BEST BUY
digit
JANUARY 2005

However, their lumen ratings were lower than the desktop models. These maxed out at 1,200 lumen for the BenQ PB2120. The same was not the case with the contrast ratio, though. This went as high as 400:1 for the tiny HP SB21. Thanks to the lower lumen rating, the lamp power consumption was well within 150 W for all units. The least hungry in terms of power was the HP sb21, with 120 W. The Panasonic, which was the lone LCD projector in this category, had a lamp that consumed 130 W—which was commendable, given that it was rated at 1,200 lumen.

The Panasonic and HP sb21 both claimed to produce 300-inch image size, quite a feat considering their size. The BenQ PB2120 was the lowest, able to project onto a 240-inch screen. All the models were native 4:3 aspect ratio projectors with an option to switch to 16:9. All four had either RCA or S-Video component inputs that allowed a direct connection to a DVD player.

Associated Cables

Data cables are vital for a portable projector. Maintenance gains paramount importance and improper storage or bundling can quickly lead to problems. Except for the HP sb21, which had an M1-A cable (DVI and USB combined), the others were bundled with a regular D-Sub cable. We found that the price of an M1-A cable was as high as Rs 7,000! We feel that replacing an M1-A cable with separate D-Sub and USB cables (along with a D-Sub to DVI converter, if needed) is a cheaper option.

Both the HP sb21 and the Sharp XR-1S had a mouse function coupled with their remote control to facilitate easy presentation. A USB interface was also included for easy plug-and-play usage. HP also had a laser pointer, adding to its overall functionality.

Presets

The Panasonic was the only model to have six presets, which included Living Room, Game and Dynamic apart from the usual ones.

This makes the Panasonic almost hassle free—you do not need to spend too much time tweaking for the best picture quality.



HP sb21

Score Board					
Brand	Model	Basic Specifications	Score (Out of 100)	Price (Rs)	
Desktop Projectors					
Acer	PD113	DLP, 800x600, 1600 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 27.5"-330", 200W/2000H, 2Kg	67.88	64,999	
BenQ	PB6100	DLP, 800x600, 1500 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 23.5"-230", 200W/2000H, 2.6Kg	62.82	69,900	
Canon	LV-S3	LCD, 800x600, 1250 lumens, 300:1 (ANSI), 4:3/16:9, 34"-200" 160W/2000H, 2.2Kg	57.97	90,000	
Epson	EMP-S1H	LCD, 800x600, 1400 lumens, 500:1 (ANSI), 4:3, 30"-300" 132W/2000H, 3.2Kg	61.97	80,000	
HP	vp6110	DLP, 800x600, 1500 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 23.5"-230", 250W/2000H, 3Kg	56.15	80,000	
Infocus	X2	DLP, 800x600, 1600 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 32.4"-259.2", 200W/4000H, 3.1Kg	63.16	70,000	
Sharp	PG-B10S	LCD, 800x600, 1200 lumens, 350:1 (ANSI), 4:3/16:9, 40"-300" 130W/2000H, 2.7Kg	63.14	77,500	
Sony	VPL-ES2	LCD, 800x600, 1500 lumens, 350:1 (ANSI), 4:3/16:9, 40"-300" 185W/3000H, 2.8Kg	66.77	79,990	
Toshiba	TDP-S20	DLP, 800x600, 1400 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 30"-300", 160W/3000H, 3Kg	60.41	82,000	
Mobile Projectors					
BenQ	PB2120	DLP, 800x600, 1200 lumens, 2000:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 12.29"-240", 150W/2000H, 1.78Kg	59.25	74,900	
HP	sb21	DLP, 800x600, 1000 lumens, 400:1 (ANSI), 4:3/16:9, 25"-300", 120W/1500H, 0.99Kg	58.66	90,000	
Panasonic	PT-LM1E-C	LCD, 800x600, 1200 lumens, 4:3/16:9, 33"-300" 130W/4000H, 1.6Kg	63.45	85,000	
Sharp	XR-1S	DLP, 800x600, 1100 lumens, 1500:1 (Full on/Off), 4:3/16:9, 30"-280", 150W/4000H, 1.45Kg	58.29	99,000	